

OFFICIAL SPEECH TRANSCRIPT — SPEECH 8

AIR DEFENSE & PREVENTION OF ATTACKS

AGENDA ITEM

Air Defense & Prevention of Attacks

Honorable Chair, Distinguished Delegates,

The delegation of Croatia strongly believes that while supplying food, medicine, and shelter is absolutely necessary, our ultimate goal must be to prevent attacks before they happen.

Today, Russian missiles, drones, and guided bombs continue to target Ukrainian neighborhoods, power grids, and water systems. From our own history in the 1990s, Croatia remembers the terror of sirens and the devastating aerial bombardment of our cities. We know firsthand that as long as the skies remain unprotected, no amount of humanitarian aid will be enough to save lives. We cannot simply rebuild hospitals only to see them targeted again.

Therefore, Croatia urges NATO member states to coordinate and accelerate the delivery of modern air defense systems to Ukraine.

By securing Ukraine's airspace, we can protect schools, keep energy grids running, and allow families to stay safely in their homes rather than fleeing as refugees.

Let us remember: humanitarian aid treats the wounds of this war, but air defense prevents them from being inflicted in the first place.

Thank you, and I yield my time back to the Chair.

Delegation of Croatia
North Atlantic Council Session